

STAGE TWELVE • LEADERSHIP

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Three sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 30 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Twelve • Leadership

OVERVIEW

Stage Twelve's thirty FIRSTS split across three sessions, matching the Manual's existing structure: Leadership Foundations, Leading & Developing People, and Advanced & Reflective Leadership. Each session pairs short facilitator framing with individual reflection and planning; several FIRSTS ask participants to commit to a real action (a decision, a conversation, a delegation) that plays out after the session, not during it.

This stage works best when participants have at least some real leadership context to draw on — a job, a club, a class project, a team. If your cohort is very early-career with limited leadership experience, expect more reliance on observation of others and forward-looking commitments than on reflection on extensive past experience, and adjust framing accordingly rather than assuming a deep well of leadership stories to draw from.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Leadership Foundations — P1-P10	~115 min
Session 2	Leading & Developing People — P11-P20	~120 min
Session 3	Advanced & Reflective Leadership — P21-P30	~120 min

SESSION 1

Leadership Foundations

Covers FIRSTS P1-P10: Leadership Awareness, Leadership Style Assessment, Leadership Responsibility, Leadership Role, Meeting Led, Team Goal Set, Vision Communicated, Task Delegation, Accountability System Created, Leadership Decision Made.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring to mind one leader they genuinely respect and one authority figure they don't, for use in FIRST P1.
- If a free personality/leadership style assessment is part of your program (e.g., a leadership styles inventory), send it as pre-work so FIRST P2 can start from a completed result.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: leadership is earned through trust, not granted by title	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST P1 — Leadership Awareness: authority vs. genuine leadership	Solo, then pairs share
0:25–0:45	FIRST P2 — Leadership Style Assessment	Solo
0:45–1:00	FIRST P3 — Leadership Responsibility: identify a real outcome to own	Solo

1:00–1:05	Short break	—
1:05–1:20	FIRST P4 — Leadership Role: commit to an upcoming opportunity	Solo
1:20–1:40	FIRST P5 — Meeting Led: plan a real meeting	Solo
1:40–1:55	FIRST P6 — Team Goal Set	Solo
1:55–2:15	FIRSTS P7–P8 — Vision Communicated + Task Delegation	Solo
2:15–2:35	FIRSTS P9–P10 — Accountability System + Leadership Decision Made + close	Solo, then full-group share

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST P1's paired share works well as a quick, energizing discussion — keep it to under 5 minutes per pair to protect time for the rest of the session.
- Several FIRSTS here (P4, P5, P9, P10) are genuinely forward-looking commitments, not things completed in the room — frame them explicitly as launched today, followed up on independently.

SESSION 2

Leading & Developing People

Covers FIRSTS P11–P20: Difficult Decision Made, Leadership Communication, Team Motivation Exercise, Person Mentored, Person Coached, Constructive Feedback Given as a Leader, Difficult Feedback Conversation, Conflict Handled as a Leader, Team Performance Review, Leadership Presentation.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one person they currently lead, mentor, or coach in some capacity (formally or informally) to reference throughout this session.
- Ask participants to identify one difficult feedback conversation or team conflict they've genuinely been avoiding, for use later in this session.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + bridge: Session 1 built the foundation; today is where leadership meets real people	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRST P11 — Difficult Decision Made: work through a real one with explicit criteria	Solo
0:30–0:45	FIRST P12 — Leadership Communication: plan to confirm understanding	Solo
0:45–1:00	FIRST P13 — Team Motivation Exercise	Solo
1:00–1:05	Short break	—
1:05–1:25	FIRSTS P14–P15 — Person Mentored + Person Coached: distinguish the two	Solo, then pairs practice a coaching question
1:25–1:45	FIRSTS P16–P17 — Constructive Feedback + Difficult Feedback Conversation	Solo
1:45–2:05	FIRST P18 — Conflict Handled as a Leader	Solo
2:05–2:25	FIRSTS P19–P20 — Team Performance Review + Leadership Presentation + close	Solo, then full-group share

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRSTS P14 and P15 are easy to conflate; the pair-practice coaching question exercise makes the distinction concrete — don't skip it even if time is tight.
- P17 and P18 both involve real, sometimes uncomfortable planning — give genuine room rather than rushing through them back to back.
- This is the longest content session in the stage; consider a second short break if your cohort's energy flags.

SESSION 3

Advanced & Reflective Leadership

Covers FIRSTS P21–P30: Cross-Functional Leadership Experience, Leadership Without Authority, Stakeholder Influence Exercise, Crisis Leadership Exercise, Leadership Under Pressure, Strategic Leadership Exercise, Leadership Feedback Received, Leadership Mistake Reflection, Leadership Philosophy, Leadership Development Plan.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to think of one person they need to influence without formal authority over them, for use in FIRST P22.
- This is the final session of the stage; let participants know they'll close with a leadership philosophy and forward-looking development plan, not just a session-level wrap-up.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today moves from leading a single team to leading in more complex, less controlled situations	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST P21 — Cross-Functional Leadership Experience	Solo
0:25–0:45	FIRSTS P22–P23 — Leadership Without Authority + Stakeholder Influence Exercise	Solo
0:45–1:05	FIRSTS P24–P25 — Crisis Leadership + Leadership Under Pressure	Solo
1:05–1:10	Short break	—
1:10–1:25	FIRST P26 — Strategic Leadership Exercise	Solo
1:25–1:40	FIRST P27 — Leadership Feedback Received: plan how to ask	Solo
1:40–1:55	FIRST P28 — Leadership Mistake Reflection	Solo
1:55–2:15	FIRST P29 — Leadership Philosophy: draft 2–3 sentences	Solo, then optional pair share
2:15–2:35	FIRST P30 — Leadership Development Plan + full-stage close	Solo, then full-group share

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST P28 (Mistake Reflection) can surface genuine discomfort or embarrassment — normalize explicitly that every leader has real mistakes to reflect on, including the facilitator.
- FIRST P29 works well shared in pairs before the full-group close — hearing another person's philosophy often sharpens one's own.
- Close the full stage by having each participant name their single highest-priority milestone from FIRST P30 out loud — concrete, not aspirational.